Collaborative Science for Conservation: Connecting Research, Partnerships, and Action

Thu, October 29th
12:00 – 1:00 PM
DM 164
Zoom: fiu.zoom.us/j/88630594826?pwd=j08y33u9oFQBfif4GRY89fSZ8ZgBmj.1

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Effective conservation requires more than scientific discovery; it demands collaboration, shared expertise, and translating research into meaningful management outcomes. Throughout my career as a Research Ecologist with the U.S. Geological Survey, I have embraced an interdisciplinary, partnership-driven approach to addressing complex conservation challenges. My research spans Florida, the Gulf of Mexico, the Atlantic seaboard, and the Greater Caribbean, focusing on the ecology, movements, and conservation of marine and coastal species of conservation concern. This work highlights the importance of understanding wildlife and ecosystems across geographic, institutional, and disciplinary boundaries. Successful conservation depends on partnerships among federal and state agencies, universities, resource managers, and local stakeholders. By integrating diverse expertise, perspectives, and resources, collaborative science generates innovative solutions and strengthens the connection between research and management. Ultimately, our greatest conservation successes occur when science is shared, partnerships are strengthened, and knowledge is translated into meaningful action